

Word family: **license / licence / licenses / licences / licensed / licensing / licensee / licensor / licensure / unlicensed / relicensing / sublicense**

Base word: license / licence

Verb: license

Past tense: licensed

Past participle: licensed

***-ing* form:** licensing

Major related forms:

* licensee

* licensor

* licensure

* licensed

* unlicensed

* licensing

* sublicense / sublicence

* sublicensee

* sublicensor

* relicense / rellicence

* relicensing

* cross-license / cross-licence

A major spelling point first:

British / Hong Kong-style English

* **licence** = noun

* **license** = verb

American English

* **license** = both noun and verb

Oxford and Cambridge both recognize **licence** as the normal British noun and **license** as the normal American noun; Oxford also lists **license** as the main verb spelling, with **licence** as a less frequent British verb variant. ([[牛津學習者詞典](#)][1])

Because your passage is Hong Kong-oriented, I would normally write:

> **licensing rules**

and

> **a business licence**

not:

> *a business license*

unless following American spelling.

I'll keep **license** as the database headword because that is the form you selected, while marking British **licence** where relevant.

Your passage:

> "...food waste, **licensing rules**, supplier problems..."

Meaning in this passage

Here, **licensing** refers to:

> **the system of official permissions and regulatory approvals that a café or food business may need in order to operate legally.**

繁體中文：

* **牌照規定**

* **發牌規例**

* **許可證制度**

* **領牌要求**

So:

> **licensing rules**

= **「牌照規定 / 發牌要求」**

The writer is contrasting the attractive image of café ownership with the regulatory reality of running a business.

A. LICENCE = OFFICIAL PERMISSION

1. **licence** = official permission to do, own, use, or operate something (許可 ; 牌照)

This is the central sense.

> "The business needs a licence to operate."

「這門生意需要取得**牌照**才能營運。」

Legally, a licence is broadly permission from an authority allowing something that would otherwise be prohibited; it may also refer to the document embodying that permission. ([法律資訊機構][2])

B. LICENCE = THE ACTUAL DOCUMENT

2. **licence = physical/electronic document proving permission (許可證 ; 執照 ; 牌照) **

> “Please show me your licence.”

「請出示你的**牌照 / 許可證**。」

So **licence** can mean either:

abstract

permission itself

or

concrete

the document proving that permission.

C. BUSINESS LICENCE

3. **business licence = business operation permit/licence (商業牌照) **

> “The owner applied for a business licence.”

「店主申請了**商業牌照**。」

Exact licences required depend on:

* jurisdiction;

* industry;

* activity.

D. OPERATING LICENCE

4. **operating licence = permission to operate a regulated business/system (營運牌照) **

> “The company cannot begin service until it receives an operating licence.”

「公司取得**營運牌照**前不能開始服務。」

Oxford specifically gives **operating licences** as a standard construction. ([牛津學習者詞典][3])

E. CAFÉ / RESTAURANT LICENSING

5. **food-business / restaurant licence**

A café may require one or more official approvals relating to:

- * food preparation;
- * premises;
- * hygiene;
- * alcohol;
- * entertainment;
- * outdoor seating,

depending on jurisdiction.

So your phrase:

> **licensing rules**

is deliberately broad.

It means:

> all the regulatory licence requirements that must be dealt with before/during operation.

F. LICENSING = SYSTEM / PROCESS OF GRANTING LICENCES

6. **licensing = process/system by which permission is granted and regulated (發牌 ; 許可制度) **

> “Licensing is handled by the local authority.”

「**發牌工作**由地方當局負責。」

7. **licensing rules = 發牌規則**

8. **licensing requirements = 牌照要求**

9. **licensing regime/system = 發牌制度**

Formal.

G. LICENSING AUTHORITY

10. **licensing authority = body responsible for issuing/regulating licences (發牌機構)**

Could be:

- * government agency;
- * local authority;
- * professional board;
- * regulator.

H. LICENSING BOARD

11. **licensing board = 發牌委員會 / 牌照機構**

Especially in professional/regulatory systems.

I. APPLY FOR A LICENCE

12. **apply for a licence = 申請牌照**

> “The company applied for a licence.”

「公司申請了**牌照**。」

J. OBTAIN / GET A LICENCE

13. **obtain a licence = 取得牌照**

Formal.

14. **get a licence = 取得牌照**

Everyday.

K. HOLD A LICENCE

15. **hold a licence = 持有有效牌照**

> “Only licensed operators may provide the service.”

「只有持牌營辦者可以提供該服務。」

L. ISSUE / GRANT A LICENCE

16. **issue a licence = 發出牌照**

Usually authority → applicant.

17. **grant a licence = 授予許可**

Can be:

* government/regulatory;

* private contractual.

M. REFUSE / DENY A LICENCE

18. **refuse a licence = 拒發牌照**

> “The authority refused the application.”

N. RENEW A LICENCE

19. **renew a licence = 續牌 / 續期**

> “The restaurant must renew its licence annually.”

「餐廳必須定期**續牌**。」

Exact period varies.

O. LICENCE EXPIRY

20. **licence expires = 牌照到期**

> “The licence expires in December.”

「牌照十二月**到期**。」

21. **expiry / expiration date**

= 有效期屆滿日期.

P. VALID / EXPIRED LICENCE

22. **valid licence = 有效牌照**

23. **expired licence = 已過期牌照**

Q. SUSPEND A LICENCE

24. **suspend a licence = 暫停牌照效力**

The licence remains formally existent but cannot be used normally during the suspension.

R. REVOKE A LICENCE

25. **revoke a licence = 撤銷牌照**

More serious/final than ordinary suspension.

Oxford lists **revoke a licence** as a standard collocation. ([牛津學習者詞典][4])

S. CANCEL A LICENCE

26. **cancel a licence = 取消牌照**

Exact legal distinction between:

- * cancel;
- * revoke;
- * terminate

depends on the regulatory scheme.

T. SURRENDER A LICENCE

27. **surrender a licence = 主動交回 / 放棄牌照**

You just mapped **surrender**.

> “The operator surrendered its licence.”

「營辦者主動**交回牌照**。」

Different from:

> licence being revoked by regulator.

U. LICENCE FEE

28. **licence fee = 牌照費**

Money paid for obtaining/maintaining permission.

V. LICENCE HOLDER

29. **licence holder = 持牌人**

The person/entity legally holding the licence.

W. LICENCE NUMBER

30. **licence number = 牌照編號**

Identifying number attached to a particular licence.

X. DRIVER'S / DRIVING LICENCE

31. **driving licence — BrE = 駕駛執照**

32. **driver's license — AmE = 駕駛執照**

Cambridge and Oxford explicitly distinguish British **driving licence** from American **driver's license**.

Y. LEARNER / PROVISIONAL LICENCE

33. **learner's licence / provisional licence = 學習 / 暫准駕駛執照**

Allows driving under specified restrictions.

Exact system differs by jurisdiction.

Z. FULL DRIVING LICENCE

34. **full licence = 正式 / 完整駕駛執照**

Contrasts with:

- * learner;

- * provisional/restricted licence.

AA. COMMERCIAL DRIVER'S LICENCE

35. **commercial driver's license / CDL = 商業車輛駕駛執照**

Especially U.S. terminology.

Needed for specified categories of commercial vehicles.

AB. PILOT'S LICENCE

36. **pilot's licence = 飛行員執照**

> “She obtained a private pilot's licence.”

「她取得私人飛行員**執照**。」

Oxford lists this construction. ([牛津學習者詞典][3])

AC. PROFESSIONAL LICENCE

37. **professional licence = 專業執業牌照 / 執照**

Permission required to practise a regulated profession.

Examples may include:

- * medicine;

- * nursing;

- * pharmacy;

- * engineering;

- * real-estate brokerage;

- * contracting,

depending on jurisdiction.

Cornell explicitly identifies professional licences as a major public-licensing category. ([法律資訊機構][2])

AD. LICENCE TO PRACTISE

38. **licence to practise/practice = 執業許可**

> “A doctor must hold the relevant licence to practise.”

「醫生必須持有所需的**執業許可**。」

Exact terminology varies by profession/country.

AE. LICENSED PROFESSIONAL

39. **licensed professional = 持牌專業人士**

Meaning:

> professionally authorized by the relevant regulator.

AF. LICENSED TO TEACH / PRACTISE / OPERATE

40. **be licensed to + verb = 獲准 / 持牌進行某活動**

> “She is licensed to practise medicine.”

「她獲准 / 持牌**行醫**。」

> “The company is licensed to operate.”

「該公司已獲發牌**營運**。」

Cambridge and Oxford both record **license someone/something to do something** as a central verb construction. ([劍橋詞典][6])

AG. LICENSURE

41. **licensure = official granting/status of professional permission (執照制度 ; 取得執照資格) **

Especially AmE/professional-regulation terminology.

Examples:

* medical licensure

* teacher licensure

* nursing licensure

It focuses more on:

> regulated professional authorization/status

than on one physical licence document.

AH. OCCUPATIONAL LICENSING

42. **occupational licensing = 職業牌照制度**

A legal/regulatory system requiring people to obtain official permission before working in a specified occupation.

AI. LICENSING VS CERTIFICATION

Important distinction.

licensing

normally concerns legal authorization to practise/do something.

certification

normally confirms training, competence, or a standard.

A certificate does **not automatically** constitute legal permission to practise.

Exact terminology varies by field.

AJ. LICENSING VS REGISTRATION

licensing

grants authorization.

registration

records a person/entity on an official register.

Some professions require:

- * both;
- * only registration;
- * only licensing.

Do not assume they are synonymous.

AK. LICENCE VS PERMIT

licence

broad authorization/status to conduct an activity.

permit

often permission for a particular act/project/place/time.

But real legal terminology varies enormously, and many systems use the two almost interchangeably. Cornell notes that licence may sometimes refer to a document also described as a **permit**. ([法律資訊機構][2])

AL. LICENCE VS CERTIFICATE

licence

permission to do something.

certificate

document confirming a fact/status/qualification.

A certificate may support a licence application without itself being the licence.

AM. IMPORT LICENCE

43. **import licence = 進口許可證**

Permission to import specified goods.

AN. EXPORT LICENCE

44. **export licence = 出口許可證**

Permission to export specified goods/technology.

Oxford explicitly gives **export licence** as a standard example. ([牛津學習者詞典][3])

AO. FISHING LICENCE

45. **fishing licence = 釣魚 / 捕魚許可證**

Allows fishing under specified rules.

AP. HUNTING LICENCE

46. **hunting licence = 狩獵許可證**

Jurisdiction-specific.

AQ. MARRIAGE LICENCE

47. **marriage licence = 結婚許可證**

Used in jurisdictions requiring formal authorization before marriage ceremony/registration.

Cornell lists marriage licences as a common public-licence example. ([法律資訊機構][2])

AR. BROADCAST LICENCE

48. **broadcasting licence = 廣播牌照**

Authorization to operate a regulated broadcast service.

May be connected with:

- * spectrum;
- * content/service regulation;
- * operator authorization,

depending on legal system.

AS. SPECTRUM LICENCE

49. **spectrum licence = 無線電頻譜使用牌照**

Permission to use specified radio frequencies/bands under regulatory conditions.

AT. TV LICENCE

50. **television / TV licence = 電視牌照**

In some countries, a household/user may have a legal licensing obligation connected with receiving/watching television services.

This is a jurisdiction-specific institutional term.

AU. MUSIC / ENTERTAINMENT LICENCE — PREMISES

51. **music licence = 音樂播放 / 表演許可**

A business may need permission connected with:

- * public performance;
- * recorded music;
- * entertainment,

depending on jurisdiction and rights involved.

Oxford gives ****music licence**** and ****entertainment licence**** as ordinary examples. ([牛津學習者詞典][3])

AV. ALCOHOL LICENCE

52. ****alcohol/liquor licence = 酒牌****

Official permission for specified sale/service of alcoholic beverages.

Exact licence categories differ by jurisdiction.

AW. LICENSED PREMISES

53. ****licensed premises = 持牌場所****

Especially BrE, often:

> premises licensed for sale of alcohol or another regulated activity.

AX. LICENSEE — ALCOHOL/PREMISES SENSE

54. ****licensee = person holding a licence (持牌人)****

General legal/business meaning.

In British English, ****licensee**** can also specifically mean a person licensed to sell alcoholic drinks. Oxford explicitly records both senses. ([牛津學習者詞典][7])

AY. LICENSOR

55. ****licensor = party granting the licence (許可方；授權方)****

In IP/software/property agreements:

> licensor gives permission.

AZ. LICENSEE

56. **licensee = party receiving the licence (被授權方 ; 持牌方) **

Cornell defines a licensee as the party receiving limited rights or permission from a licensor. ([法律資訊機構][8])

BA. LICENSOR VS LICENSEE

licensor

gives permission.

licensee

receives permission.

An easy memory aid:

> employ**er** gives work → employ**ee** receives work

> licens**or** grants → licens**ee** receives.

BB. VERB: LICENSE SOMEONE

57. **license someone = officially authorize them (向某人發牌 / 授權) **

> “The regulator licenses operators.”

「監管機構向營辦者**發牌**。」

BC. LICENSE A BUSINESS

58. **license a business = authorize it to operate (向企業發牌) **

BD. LICENSE A PRODUCT

59. **license a product = authorize its manufacture/use/distribution under rights**

Can involve:

- * IP;
- * regulatory approval;
- * brand permissions,

depending on context.

BE. LICENSE TECHNOLOGY

60. **license technology to another company = 授權另一公司使用技術**

> “The university licensed the technology to a manufacturer.”

Cambridge uses almost exactly this type of example. ([劍橋詞典][6])

BF. INTELLECTUAL-PROPERTY LICENCE

61. **IP licence = 知識產權授權**

An owner permits another party to use specified intellectual property without transferring ownership itself.

Cornell notes that IP licences can cover:

- * patents;
- * trademarks;
- * creative works,

and often involve contractual terms and royalties. ([法律資訊機構][2])

BG. COPYRIGHT LICENCE

62. **copyright licence = 版權授權**

Allows specified acts involving copyrighted work, for example:

- * copying;
- * distributing;
- * adapting;
- * performing,

depending on licence terms.

BH. PATENT LICENCE

63. **patent licence = 專利授權**

Allows specified use of patented invention/rights.

The patent owner retains ownership while granting limited rights to the licensee.

BI. TRADEMARK LICENCE

64. **trademark licence = 商標授權**

Allows another party to use a trademark under specified conditions.

Often involves quality/control obligations under applicable law.

BJ. BRAND LICENSING

65. **brand licensing = 品牌授權**

A brand owner allows another party to use:

- * brand name;
- * characters;
- * logos;
- * designs,

for specified products/services.

BK. MERCHANDISING LICENCE

66. **merchandising licence = 商品化授權**

Permission to use IP/brand/content on commercial merchandise.

BL. LICENSED PRODUCT

67. **licensed product = 授權產品**

A product made/sold using officially licensed:

- * brand;
- * character;
- * patent;
- * technology;
- * copyright content.

BM. **UNDER LICENCE**

68. **made / produced under licence = 經授權生產**

> “The product is manufactured locally under licence.”

Oxford records **under licence/license** as a standard idiom meaning manufactured with another organization’s permission. ([牛津學習者詞典][4])

BN. LICENCE AGREEMENT

69. **licence agreement = 授權協議**

Contract setting out:

- * what is licensed;
- * permitted uses;
- * territory;
- * duration;
- * payment;
- * restrictions;

* termination.

BO. LICENCE TERM

70. **licence term = 授權期限**

Period during which permission remains effective.

BP. TERRITORIAL LICENCE

71. **territorial licence = 特定地域授權**

Rights may be limited to:

* Hong Kong;

* Asia;

* worldwide,

etc.

BQ. FIELD-OF-USE LICENCE

72. **field-of-use licence = 特定用途 / 領域授權**

Allows technology/IP use only in specified sectors/applications.

BR. EXCLUSIVE LICENCE

73. **exclusive licence = 獨家授權**

The licensee receives exclusivity within the scope defined by the agreement.

Precise legal consequences vary by IP type/jurisdiction.

BS. NON-EXCLUSIVE LICENCE

74. **non-exclusive licence = 非獨家授權**

Licensor may generally grant similar rights to multiple licensees.

BT. SOLE LICENCE

75. **sole licence = 單一被授權方安排**

A specialist contractual category sometimes distinguished from **exclusive** licensing.

Exact meaning depends heavily on agreement and jurisdiction, so do not assume the label alone settles all rights.

BU. ROYALTY-BEARING LICENCE

76. **royalty-bearing licence = 需支付特許權使用費的授權**

Licensee pays royalties according to agreed method.

BV. ROYALTY-FREE LICENCE

77. **royalty-free licence = 無需按每次使用另付特許權使用費的授權**

Important:

> **royalty-free ≠ necessarily free of charge**

There may still be:

- * upfront fee;
- * subscription;
- * other conditions.

BW. PERPETUAL LICENCE

78. **perpetual licence = 永久授權**

Permission does not have a predetermined expiration date, subject to contractual terms.

Often used in software.

BX. TERM / FIXED-TERM LICENCE

79. **term licence = 定期授權**

Valid only for specified duration.

BY. SUBLICENCE

80. **sublicence / sublicense = 再授權**

A licensee grants some of its licensed rights onward to another party **if the original agreement permits it**.

BZ. SUBLICENSEE

81. **sublicensee = 再被授權方**

Recipient of sublicensed rights.

CA. CROSS-LICENCE

82. **cross-license = 交叉授權**

Two parties grant each other rights to specified IP.

Common in:

* patents;

* technology.

CB. COMPULSORY LICENCE

83. **compulsory licence = 強制授權**

A licence permitted/required by law without relying solely on the right holder's ordinary voluntary consent, under specified statutory conditions.

Occurs in some:

- * copyright;
- * patent

regimes.

Exact rules are highly jurisdiction-specific.

CC. STATUTORY LICENCE

84. **statutory licence = 法定授權**

Permission created/governed directly by statute rather than purely negotiated private agreement.

CD. SOFTWARE LICENCE

85. **software licence = 軟件使用授權**

Defines what users may legally do with software.

Possible terms cover:

- * installation;
- * copying;
- * modification;
- * distribution;
- * number of users/devices.

CE. END-USER LICENCE AGREEMENT

86. **EULA = End-User Licence Agreement (終端用戶授權協議) **

Agreement governing end user's use of software.

CF. SINGLE-USER LICENCE

87. ****single-user licence = 單一用戶授權****

Permission intended for one user, under specified terms.

Oxford explicitly gives ****single-user licence**** as an example. ([牛津學習者詞典][3])

CG. SITE LICENCE

88. ****site licence = 場地 / 機構授權****

Allows use across a specified site/institution.

Common for:

- * universities;
- * companies;
- * schools.

Oxford lists ****site license**** as a standard software example. ([牛津學習者詞典][9])

CH. PER-SEAT / PER-USER LICENSING

89. ****per-user licence = 按用戶授權****

Rights/costs calculated by number of named users.

90. ****per-device licence = 按設備授權****

Calculated by devices.

CI. CONCURRENT / FLOATING LICENCE

91. ****concurrent licence = 並發授權****

Allows a specified number of users to use software simultaneously.

92. **floating licence = 浮動授權**

Licence pool shared across multiple users/machines, subject to concurrent-use limits.

CJ. VOLUME LICENSING

93. **volume licensing = 批量授權**

Licensing arrangement for many users/devices within an organization.

CK. ENTERPRISE LICENCE

94. **enterprise licence = 企業級授權**

Covers organization-wide or broadly defined enterprise use according to contract.

CL. SUBSCRIPTION LICENCE

95. **subscription licence = 訂閱式授權**

Right to use software/content while subscription remains active.

CM. SOFTWARE LICENCE KEY

96. **licence key = 授權金鑰 / 產品金鑰**

Code used to activate/verify licensed software.

Important:

> key itself is not the legal licence.

It is a technical mechanism associated with it.

CN. OPEN-SOURCE LICENCE

97. **open-source licence = 開源授權**

An open-source licence grants freedoms consistent with the Open Source Definition, including redistribution and access to/modification of source code under the licence terms. OSI emphasizes that “open source” means more than merely being able to view source code. ([開放源碼倡議][10])

CO. PERMISSIVE OPEN-SOURCE LICENCE

98. **permissive licence = 寬鬆型開源授權**

Generally imposes relatively limited conditions on reuse.

Examples often include families such as:

- * MIT;
- * BSD;
- * Apache,

subject to their exact terms.

CP. COPYLEFT LICENCE

99. **copyleft licence = 著佐權 / 互惠式開源授權**

Broadly requires certain redistributed derivatives to remain under the same or compatible licence terms.

Exact obligations depend on the licence.

CQ. SOURCE-AVAILABLE VS OPEN SOURCE

Important distinction.

open source

must satisfy the Open Source Definition.

source available

source code can be viewed/accessed, but restrictions may prevent it from qualifying as open source.

OSI explicitly states that open source is not simply access to source code. ([開放源碼倡議][11])

CR. CREATIVE COMMONS LICENCE

100. **Creative Commons licence = 創用 CC 授權 / 知識共享授權**

Used for copyrighted creative works such as:

- * text;
- * images;
- * educational material;
- * media.

Creative Commons currently provides six core CC licence types; all six require attribution, while additional conditions may include:

- * NonCommercial;
- * NoDerivatives;
- * ShareAlike. ([創用CC][12])

CS. CC BY

101. **CC BY = 姓名標示授權**

Allows broad reuse/adaptation subject to attribution requirements. ([創用CC][13])

CT. CC BY-SA

102. **CC BY-SA = 姓名標示—相同方式分享**

Adaptations distributed under applicable terms must use the same/compatible share-alike framework. ([創用CC][13])

CU. CC BY-NC

103. **CC BY-NC = 姓名標示—非商業性**

Permits specified reuse/adaptation for noncommercial purposes subject to attribution. ([創用CC]
[14])

CV. DATA LICENCE

104. **data licence = 資料使用授權**

Defines permitted:

- * access;
- * reuse;
- * redistribution;
- * modification

of datasets.

CW. CONTENT LICENCE

105. **content licence = 內容授權**

Permission to use:

- * articles;
- * video;
- * images;
- * music;
- * other content.

CX. MUSIC LICENSING — RIGHTS USE

Separate from a premises/music-venue licence.

106. **music licensing = 音樂版權授權**

Permission to use music in specified ways.

May involve separate rights depending on use.

CY. SYNCHRONIZATION LICENCE

107. **sync licence / synchronization licence = 同步授權**

Permission to synchronize musical composition with:

- * film;
- * television;
- * video;
- * advertisement.

Specialist media/IP term.

CZ. MECHANICAL LICENCE

108. **mechanical licence = 機械複製授權**

Copyright/music term concerning reproduction/distribution of musical compositions in specified formats/usages.

Exact legal regime varies by jurisdiction.

DA. PUBLIC-PERFORMANCE LICENCE

109. **public-performance licence = 公開表演授權**

Permission to perform/use copyrighted material publicly under the applicable rights framework.

DB. MASTER-USE LICENCE

110. **master-use licence = 錄音母帶使用授權**

Permission relating to use of a particular sound recording.

Different from rights in the underlying musical composition.

DC. FRANCHISE VS LICENCE

Important business distinction.

licence

permission to use specified rights/property.

franchise

typically a broader business relationship involving:

- * brand;
- * business model;
- * operating system;
- * ongoing controls/support.

A franchise usually contains licences, but:

> **licence ≠ automatically franchise.**

DD. PROPERTY LAW: LICENCE TO ENTER/USE LAND

111. **property licence = permission to enter/use someone else's land (土地使用許可) **

In common-law property terminology, a licence can permit entry/use that would otherwise amount to trespass. Cornell expressly records this real-property sense. ([法律資訊機構][2])

DE. LICENCE VS LEASE

licence

permission to use/occupy, generally without necessarily creating the same proprietary estate as a lease.

lease

typically grants a leasehold interest/right of possession for a term under property law.

Legal classification depends on substance, not merely what the document is titled.

DF. LICENCE VS EASEMENT

licence

personal permission to use land.

easement

property right benefiting land/person in a more durable proprietary sense.

Exact common-law doctrine varies by jurisdiction.

DG. BARE LICENCE

112. **bare licence = permission to enter/use land without contractual consideration — common-law specialist**

Usually revocable subject to applicable rules.

Low-priority property-law term.

DH. CONTRACTUAL LICENCE

113. **contractual licence = licence created by contract**

The contractual terms may govern:

- * duration;
- * payment;
- * termination;
- * use.

DI. LICENCE COUPLED WITH AN INTEREST

114. **licence coupled with an interest = property-law licence connected to another proprietary interest**

Specialist common-law doctrine.

Very low priority for ordinary learners, but genuine.

DJ. LICENSE PLATE — AMERICAN ENGLISH

115. **license plate = vehicle registration plate (車牌) **

Especially AmE.

British English normally prefers:

* number plate;

* registration plate.

DK. LICENSE NUMBER — VEHICLE

116. **license number / license-plate number = 車牌號碼 — AmE**

Oxford contrasts North American **license number** with British **registration number**.

([牛津學習者詞典][15])

DL. LICENSE = FREEDOM / LATITUDE

Now a completely different major abstract branch.

117. **licence = freedom to act as one chooses (自由 ; 行動空間) — formal**

> “The manager gave the designer considerable licence.”

「經理給設計師很大的**自由發揮空間**。」

Cambridge and Oxford both record this formal sense of freedom/latitude. ([劍橋詞典][16])

DM. GIVE SOMEONE LICENCE TO DO SOMETHING

118. **give someone licence to X = allow broad freedom to do X**

> “The brief gave the architect licence to experiment.”

「這份要求給建築師充分**自由去嘗試**。」

DN. LICENCE = EXCESSIVE / UNRESTRAINED FREEDOM

119. **licence = excessive freedom to behave badly (放縱 ; 任意妄為的自由) **

> “Freedom should not become licence.”

「自由不應變成**放縱**。」

This is an old but still useful formal distinction:

liberty/freedom

legitimate freedom.

licence

freedom carried beyond acceptable limits.

Oxford explicitly records this sense, including behaviour regarded as unacceptable. ([牛津學習者詞典][4])

DO. OLD/FORMAL SEXUAL-MORAL SENSE

120. **licence = sexually immoral/unrestrained behaviour — formal/older**

Oxford still records a formal sense involving freedom to behave in a way considered sexually immoral. ([牛津學習者詞典][4])

繁體中文：

* **放蕩**

* **縱慾**

* **放縱**

Very low priority in modern general usage.

DP. ARTISTIC LICENCE

121. **artistic licence = 藝術創作自由**

Freedom to alter:

- * reality;
- * facts;
- * proportion;
- * chronology;

for artistic effect.

> “The film takes some artistic licence.”

「電影作了一些**藝術上的改編 / 自由處理**。」

Cambridge and Oxford both recognize this fixed expression. ([劍橋詞典][16])

DQ. POETIC LICENCE

122. **poetic licence = 詩意 / 文學創作上的自由處理**

Writers may depart from:

- * factual accuracy;
- * conventional grammar;
- * ordinary usage

for artistic effect.

DR. CREATIVE LICENCE

123. **creative licence = 創作自由**

Broader modern equivalent covering many creative disciplines.

DS. TAKE ARTISTIC / POETIC LICENCE

124. **take artistic licence = 為創作效果而偏離嚴格事實**

> “The series takes considerable dramatic licence with the events.”

「劇集為戲劇效果對事件作了相當大的**自由改編**。」

DT. LICENCE TO DO SOMETHING — LITERAL

125. **a licence to do X = official permission**

> “The firm has a licence to operate.”

「公司有**營運許可**。」

DU. LICENCE TO DO SOMETHING — FIGURATIVE

126. **licence to do X = supposed/unrestricted permission (可以任意做.....的權利) **

Often negative:

> “Success is not a licence to ignore the rules.”

「成功並不代表你有權**任意無視規則**。」

This does not require a physical licence.

DV. **LICENSE TO KILL**

127. **licence/license to kill = 殺人許可**

Literal/fictional sense:

> authorization to use lethal force under specified conditions.

Also figuratively:

> unusually broad unchecked authority.

Famously associated with spy fiction, but usable beyond it.

DW. ****LICENCE TO PRINT MONEY****

128. ****a licence to print money = 極容易、近乎穩賺暴利的生意****

Disapproving/humorous idiom.

Oxford defines it as a business that makes a large amount of money with very little effort. ([牛津學習者詞典][4])

> “That monopoly is practically a licence to print money.”

「那個壟斷生意簡直像一部****印鈔機****。」

DX. ****UNDER LICENCE** VS **LICENSED****

****under licence****

made/used with someone else's permission.

****licensed****

has been officially/contractually authorized.

> licensed software

> manufactured under licence.

DY. ****LICENSED** AS ADJECTIVE**

129. ****licensed = officially authorized (持牌的 ; 獲授權的) ****

Examples:

* licensed driver

* licensed restaurant

* licensed professional

* licensed software

* licensed premises.

DZ. ****UNLICENSED****

130. **unlicensed = without the required licence (無牌的 ; 未獲授權的) **

> “The operator was unlicensed.”

「該營辦者**沒有牌照**。」

Can apply to:

- * business;
- * software;
- * profession;
- * driving;
- * broadcasting.

EA. UNLICENSED SOFTWARE

131. **unlicensed software = 未獲合法授權使用的軟件**

May refer to software being used outside permitted licence terms.

EB. UNLICENSED PRACTICE

132. **unlicensed practice = 無牌執業**

Providing a regulated service without required professional authorization.

EC. RELICENSE

133. **relicense / relicense = change or renew the licence terms (重新授權 / 改用另一授權) **

Especially:

- * software;
- * content;
- * IP.

ED. RELICENSING

134. **relicensing = 重新授權 / 更改授權條款**

Can mean:

- * renew regulatory permission;
- * change IP/software licence;
- * grant rights again.

Context determines.

EE. LICENCE COMPATIBILITY

135. **licence compatibility = 授權條款相容性**

Especially open-source/content licensing.

Question:

> can material/code under licence A legally be combined/distributed under licence B?

Highly technical.

EF. LICENCE COMPLIANCE

136. **licence compliance = 遵守授權條款**

Could involve:

- * attribution;
- * payment;
- * user limits;
- * distribution conditions;
- * reporting.

EG. LICENCE BREACH / VIOLATION

137. **breach of licence terms = 違反授權條款**

Depending on the licence, this may have:

- * contractual;
- * IP;
- * regulatory

consequences.

EH. LICENCE CONDITIONS

138. **licence conditions = 牌照 / 授權條件**

Examples:

- * opening hours;
- * permitted activities;
- * territory;
- * reporting;
- * safety requirements.

EI. LICENCE RESTRICTIONS

139. **licence restrictions = 授權限制**

What licensee may **not** do.

EJ. LICENCE SCOPE

140. **scope of the licence = 授權範圍**

May describe:

- * permitted acts;
- * geography;
- * users;
- * products;
- * duration.

EK. IMPORTANT DISTINCTIONS

licence vs ownership

A licence gives permission.

It does **not necessarily transfer ownership**.

This is fundamental in:

- * software;
- * IP;
- * land.

Cornell explicitly describes IP licensing as allowing use while the IP owner retains ownership. ([法律資訊機構][2])

buy software vs license software

When people say:

> “I bought the software,”

legally they may often have purchased:

> a **licence to use** it,

rather than ownership of the underlying copyrighted software.

Exact rights depend on the agreement.

licence vs assignment — IP

licence

owner retains underlying IP and grants permission.

assignment

ownership of the relevant IP right is transferred.

Major legal distinction.

licence vs lease — property

licence

permission to use/enter.

lease

typically gives leasehold possession/property interest.

Do not merge them.

licensee vs owner

A **licensee** may have extensive rights of use without owning the underlying asset/IP.

licensing vs franchising

Licensing mainly grants rights.

Franchising normally creates a much broader replicated business system.

licence vs authorization

authorization

very broad permission.

licence

formalized permission/status, often documented/regulatory/contractual.

licence vs approval

approval

agreement that something is acceptable.

licence

permission to carry out regulated conduct.

Approval does not always create a licence.

licence vs registration

Already noted:

> recording status ≠ necessarily granting permission.

licensed vs qualified

qualified

has required training/ability.

licensed

legally/officially authorized.

A person can be academically qualified but not yet licensed.

licensed vs certified

certified

credential/standard confirmed.

licensed

legal authorization granted.

licence vs freedom

freedom

general ability to act without constraint.

licence

can mean formal permission or, in formal usage, excessive latitude.

licence vs liberty

A traditional philosophical/moral distinction:

liberty

legitimate freedom.

licence

unrestrained freedom that disregards rules/others.

Not every writer uses this distinction rigidly.

EL. GRAMMAR

141. **licence for + noun/activity**

> “a licence for the software”

> “a licence for food sales”

142. **licence to + verb**

> “a licence to operate”

143. **licence from + authority/licensor**

> “a licence from the regulator”

144. **licence under + law/scheme**

> “licensed under the relevant statute”

145. **license someone to do X — verb**

> “The authority licensed them to operate.”

146. **license X to Y**

In IP/business:

> “The university licensed the patent to the company.”

147. **license X for use in Y**

> “The software is licensed for commercial use.”

148. **be licensed for X**

> “The premises are licensed for entertainment.”

149. **be licensed to X**

> “She is licensed to practise.”

EM. COUNTABILITY

licence = permit/document

Countable:

> a licence
> several licences.

licence = freedom/latitude

Usually uncountable:

> artistic licence
> give someone licence to experiment.

licensing

Usually uncountable as process/system:

> software licensing
> professional licensing.

But:

> licensing arrangements

is countable via the head noun.

licensee / licensor

Countable:

> one licensee
> several licensors.

EN. FAMILY MAP

Family member / branch	Main meaning
-----	-----
licence/license — permit	official permission/document
licence — business	permission to operate a regulated business
licence — professional	legal authorization to practise
licence — vehicle	authorization to drive/operate

licence — IP	permission to use intellectual property	
licence — software	contractual permission to use software	
licence — property	permission to enter/use land	
licence — abstract latitude	freedom to act	
licence — excessive latitude	freedom carried into unacceptable conduct	
artistic/poetic licence	freedom to depart from strict fact/convention	
license — verb	officially/contractually authorize	
licensing	system/process of issuing/managing licences	
licensed	officially permitted	
unlicensed	lacking required permission	
licensee	person/entity receiving/holding licence	
licensor	person/entity granting licence	
licensure	professional authorization/status	
sublicense	onward grant of licensed rights	
relicense	grant/change licence again	

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning	
-----	-----	
licence — official	政府 / 機構正式授予某人做、持有、使用某事物的許可	
licence — document	證明已獲上述許可的牌照 / 執照 / 許可證	
business licence	允許企業進行指定商業活動的牌照	
operating licence	允許機構 / 企業正式營運的牌照	
licensing rules	關於申請、持有、遵守及續期牌照的發牌規定	
licensing authority	負責審批、發出和監管牌照的機構	
licence fee	申請 / 維持牌照所需費用	
licence holder	持有相關牌照的人 / 機構	
renew a licence	把即將到期牌照續期	
suspend a licence	暫時停止牌照效力	
revoke a licence	正式撤銷牌照	
surrender a licence	持牌人主動交回 / 放棄牌照	
driving licence / driver's license	駕駛執照	
professional licence	法律 / 監管制度要求的專業執業資格	
licensure	專業領域取得 / 維持法定執照的制度或狀態	
occupational licensing	工作某些職業前必須取得政府 / 監管牌照的制度	
import/export licence	進口 / 出口指定貨物的官方許可	
broadcast/spectrum licence	進行廣播 / 使用指定頻譜的官方牌照	
alcohol/liquor licence	依法售賣 / 供應酒類的酒牌	
licensed premises	已獲准進行指定受規管活動的持牌場所	
licensee	取得 / 持有授權的人或公司	
licensor	把使用權授予他人的權利持有人	
license — verb	正式給予某人 / 企業進行指定活動的許可	
IP licence	權利人保留知識產權所有權，但容許另一方按條款使用	
copyright licence	容許指定方式使用受版權保護作品的授權	
patent licence	容許另一方在指定範圍內使用專利權的授權	

trademark licence	容許另一方按條件使用商標的授權	
licensed product	經相關品牌 / IP 權利人正式授權製造或出售的產品	
under licence	在權利人正式許可下生產 / 使用	
licence agreement	訂明授權範圍、期限、費用等條件的合約	
exclusive licence	在界定範圍內給特定被授權方的獨家授權	
non-exclusive licence	同類權利可同時授予多個被授權方的非獨家授權	
royalty-bearing licence	使用權需要支付特許權使用費的授權	
royalty-free licence	不需逐次另付 royalty ; 不一定完全免費	
perpetual licence	沒有預設到期日、依合約條件持續有效的授權	
sublicence	在原授權容許下，把部分權利再授權第三方	
cross-licence	雙方互相授予知識產權使用權	
compulsory licence	法律在指定條件下允許 / 要求的強制授權	
software licence	規定使用者可以如何合法安裝、使用、複製等軟件的授權	
EULA	終端使用者與軟件權利方之間的使用授權協議	
single-user licence	只授權指定單一使用者使用	
site licence	授權一個指定機構 / 場地內廣泛使用	
concurrent/floating licence	以同時使用人數 / 共享授權池限制使用	
volume licence	為企業 / 機構大量使用者或設備安排的批量授權	
subscription licence	在訂閱有效期間提供的使用權	
open-source licence	符合開源原則，容許使用、修改及再分發的軟件授權	
Creative Commons licence	讓創作者預先規定作品重用、改編、商業使用等條件的標準版權授權	
data/content licence	規定資料 / 內容如何被重用、分發、修改的授權	
music licensing	對音樂作品 / 錄音的指定使用方式取得版權許可	
property licence	土地權利人容許另一人進入 / 使用土地，而不一定授予租賃權益	
license plate — AmE	車輛的車牌 / 登記牌	
licence — freedom	正式：給人很大的行動 / 創作自由	
licence — excessive freedom	不受正常規則約束而任意行事的放縱	
artistic licence	創作者為藝術效果不必完全遵從現實 / 事實的自由	
poetic licence	詩人 / 作家為文學效果偏離一般事實或語言規則的自由	
licence to do X — figurative	被視為可以任意做某件事的權限	
licence to print money	比喻幾乎不費力就能大量賺錢的生意 / 特權	
licensed	已取得法定 / 合約授權的	
unlicensed	未取得依法 / 合約要求的授權	
relicense	再次授權或改用另一套授權條款	

For your original passage

> “...food waste, ****licensing rules****, supplier problems...”

The exact meaning is:

> ****licensing rules** = all the regulatory rules about what official permissions a café must obtain and

maintain in order to operate lawfully.**

So the writer is reminding Kam Chai that a café is not merely:

> espresso + pastries + décor.

It also means dealing with:

- > applications
- > inspections
- > conditions
- > fees
- > renewals
- > compliance
- > possible licence restrictions.

That makes **licensing** part of the passage's larger contrast:

- > **romance of café ownership**
- > versus
- > **regulated commercial operation**.

A strong Traditional Chinese rendering is:

> **「租金、裝修費、員工工資、食物損耗、牌照規定、供應商問題.....」**

For your core database, I would keep **7 principal semantic branches**:

1. **official regulatory permission / licence document**
2. **professional, driving, business and other regulated authorizations**
3. **verb: officially authorize someone/something**
4. **contractual/IP/software licence — permission to use another party's rights/property**
5. **property-law licence — permission to enter/use land**
6. **abstract licence = freedom/latitude, including artistic or poetic licence**
7. **negative/formal licence = excessive freedom or licence to behave without normal restraint**

Then separately index **licensee, licensor, licensure, licensed, unlicensed, sublicence, under licence, exclusive/non-exclusive licence, software licence, open-source licence, Creative Commons licence, licence to print money**, because those have become established lexical/legal concepts rather than merely predictable combinations of 「牌照」.

[1]: https://www.oxfordlearnersdictionaries.com/us/definition/english/license_1?utm_source=chatgpt.com "license verb - Definition, pictures, pronunciation and usage notes | Oxford Advanced Learner's Dictionary at OxfordLearnersDictionaries.com"

[2]: https://www.law.cornell.edu/wex/license?utm_source=chatgpt.com "license | Wex | US Law | LII / Legal Information Institute"

[3]: https://www.oxfordlearnersdictionaries.com/definition/english/licence?utm_source=chatgpt.com "licence noun - Definition, pictures, pronunciation and usage notes | Oxford Advanced Learner's Dictionary at OxfordLearnersDictionaries.com"

[4]: https://www.oxfordlearnersdictionaries.com/definition/english/license_2?utm_source=chatgpt.com "license noun - Definition, pictures, pronunciation and usage notes | Oxford Advanced Learner's Dictionary at OxfordLearnersDictionaries.com"

[5]: https://dictionary.cambridge.org/us/dictionary/essential-british-english/licence?utm_source=chatgpt.com "LICENCE definition | Cambridge Essential English Dictionary"

[6]: https://dictionary.cambridge.org/dictionary/english/license?utm_source=chatgpt.com "LICENSE | English meaning - Cambridge Dictionary"

[7]: https://www.oxfordlearnersdictionaries.com/us/definition/english/licensee?utm_source=chatgpt.com "licensee noun - Definition, pictures, pronunciation and usage notes | Oxford Advanced Learner's Dictionary at OxfordLearnersDictionaries.com"

[8]: https://www.law.cornell.edu/wex/licensee?utm_source=chatgpt.com "licensee | Wex | US Law | LII / Legal Information Institute"

[9]: https://www.oxfordlearnersdictionaries.com/us/definition/american_english/license_1?utm_source=chatgpt.com "license noun - Definition, pictures, pronunciation and usage notes | Oxford Advanced American Dictionary at OxfordLearnersDictionaries.com"

[10]: https://opensource.org/licenses?utm_source=chatgpt.com "Licenses – Open Source Initiative"

[11]: https://opensource.org/osd?utm_source=chatgpt.com "The Open Source Definition – Open Source Initiative"

[12]: https://creativecommons.org/cc-licenses/?utm_source=chatgpt.com "Sharing Openly, Sharing Globally - Creative Commons"

[13]: https://creativecommons.org/share-your-work/use-remix/cc-licenses/?utm_source=chatgpt.com "Creative Commons Licenses - Creative Commons"

[14]: https://creativecommons.org/licenses/by-nc/4.0/?utm_source=chatgpt.com "Deed - Attribution-NonCommercial 4.0 International - Creative Commons"

[15]: https://www.oxfordlearnersdictionaries.com/us/definition/english/license-number?utm_source=chatgpt.com "license number noun - Definition, pictures, pronunciation and usage notes | Oxford Advanced Learner's Dictionary at OxfordLearnersDictionaries.com"

[16]: https://dictionary.cambridge.org/us/dictionary/english/license?utm_source=chatgpt.com "LICENSE | definition in the Cambridge English Dictionary"